STUDY AID · MATTHEW 15:1-28 · EPISODE 29 OF 58

Out of *the Heart*



This people honors Me with their lips, but their heart is far away from Me.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 15:1-28 in the LSB | 25:00 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Matthew 15:1-28 – Jesus EXPOSED This Church Tradition.... Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO | BACKGROUND (ADDED) | DEBATED | LSB TEXT | ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

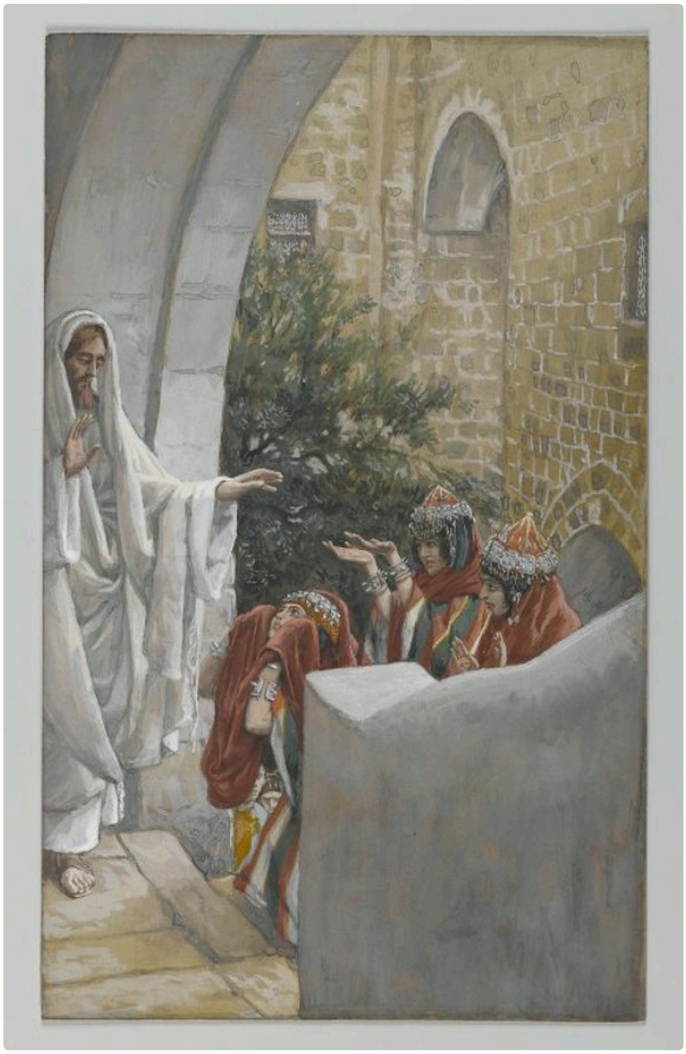
Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 15:1-28. Pharisees and scribes come from Jerusalem and ask why Jesus' disciples break the tradition of the elders by not washing their hands. Jesus answers with a question: why do they transgress God's commandment for their tradition? Their rule about gifts 'given to God' lets a son avoid honoring his parents. He quotes Isaiah 29:13, teaches that what defiles comes from the heart, and calls them blind guides. Then in the district of Tyre and Sidon a Canaanite woman's great faith wins healing for her daughter.
- The exchange starts out cordial; it turns contentious when Jesus calls them hypocrites. Their tradition is halakha, rules for how to walk out the Law in unclear cases. The video gives a Mishnah example about a poor man at the door on the Sabbath.
- Corban (Mark 7:11) let a child declare goods set aside for God and so refuse them to needy parents, voiding the command to honor father and mother (Exodus 20:12; 21:17; Deuteronomy 5:16). Like Hosea 6:6, which Jesus quoted twice before, Isaiah 29 shows God wants hearts close to Him.
- Israel was God's planting (Isaiah 60:21; Ezekiel 17:22-24; 16:7); plants He did not plant will be uprooted. 'Blind guides' recalls Isaiah 56:10 and Malachi 2:8. What defiles is what comes out of the heart; Mark adds pride (Mark 7:22). The Canaanite woman is an intentional contrast.

> *"Why does a Jewish rabbi answer a question with a question? Why not?*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Beware the heart behind religious customs or traditions.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: beware the heart behind religious customs or traditions. If the heart behind the tradition is defiled, the tradition will violate God's word. The video then asks how a church can test its own traditions.



Have mercy on me, Lord, Son of David

James Tissot, The Canaanite's Daughter, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Watch for contrasts

The teacher reads the Canaanite woman as an intentional contrast with the Pharisees and scribes just before. Set the two scenes side by side and compare who comes, what they ask, and how Jesus answers.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 15:1-28 and turns to Mark 7, Exodus 20 and 21, Deuteronomy 15, Isaiah 29, 56 and 60, Ezekiel 16 and 17, and Malachi 2. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 15:1-28
Read in full: tradition, defilement, blind guides, and the Canaanite woman.

Mark 7:1-30
Mark's longer account: Corban, pride, the Syrophoenician woman.

Exodus 20:12
Honor your father and your mother.

Exodus 21:17
He who curses his father or his mother.

Deuteronomy 15:7-11
Open your hand to the poor.

Isaiah 29:13
Near with their mouth, hearts far from Me.

Hosea 6:6
I delight in lovingkindness rather than sacrifice.

Isaiah 60:21
The branch of My planting.

Ezekiel 17:22-24
The Lord plants a cedar.

Isaiah 56:10-11
His watchmen are blind.

Malachi 2:7-8
Priests who cause many to stumble.

Matthew 15:29-39
Coming next: the four thousand.

Key verses in the LSB

> "You hypocrites, rightly did Isaiah prophesy of you: 'This people honors Me with their lips, / But their heart is far away from Me."
>
> Matthew 15:7-8 (LSB)

> "But the things that proceed out of the mouth come from the heart, and those defile the man."
>
> Matthew 15:18 (LSB)

> "Then Jesus answered and said to her, "O woman, your faith is great; it shall be done for you as you wish." And her daughter was healed at once."
>
> Matthew 15:28 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The tradition of the elders

Washing, halakha, Corban, and lips near God with hearts far away.



MATTHEW 15:1-3

A question for a question

MATTHEW 15:1-3 (LSB)

CORDIAL

“Then some Pharisees and scribes *came to Jesus from Jerusalem and said, “Why do Your disciples break the tradition of the elders? For they do not wash their hands when they eat bread.” And He answered and said to them, “Why do you yourselves transgress the commandment of God for the sake of your tradition?”

FROM THE VIDEO They came all the way from Jerusalem. So far the exchange is above board and fairly cordial; it turns contentious when Jesus calls them hypocrites (15:7).

BACKGROUND Luke records a Pharisee who marveled that Jesus 'had not first ceremonially washed before the meal' (Luke 11:38). Luke 11:38

◆ Factbook: Pharisees ◆ Factbook: Scribe ◆ Factbook: Jerusalem



TRADITION OF THE ELDERS

Halakha: how to walk

FROM THE VIDEO The tradition of the elders is halakha, from a word meaning 'to walk': rules for how to keep the Law in cases where it did not seem clear how to obey it.

FROM THE VIDEO The video's example: Deuteronomy 15 says to open your hand to the poor, and Exodus 20:10 says to rest on the Sabbath. What if a poor man comes on the Sabbath? The video describes a Mishnah case where giving across the doorway, with neither stepping through, keeps the Sabbath. Deuteronomy 15:7 Exodus 20:10

BACKGROUND The rabbis described the tradition as handed down from Moses and said, 'make a fence round the Torah' (Pirkei Avot 1:1).

◆ Factbook: Halakha ◆ Factbook: Tradition of the elders ◆ Factbook: Mishnah ◆ Factbook: Sabbath



MATTHEW 15:4-6; MARK 7:11

Corban: given to God

JESUS · MATTHEW 15:4

“For God said, ‘Honor your father and mother,’ and, ‘He who speaks evil of father or mother is to be put to death.’”

JESUS · MARK 7:11

“but you say, ‘If a man says to his father or his mother, whatever you might benefit from me is Corban (that is to say, given to God),’”

FROM THE VIDEO Honoring parents meant caring for them in need. The video says the rule let a son or daughter declare valuables set aside for the temple, to be given after their death, and so refuse to help their parents.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus quotes the Law to show the clear duty of children to care for their parents: Exodus 20:12, Exodus 21:17 and Deuteronomy 5:16. Exodus 21:17 Deuteronomy 5:16

BACKGROUND The Mishnah lists 'konam' as a substitute for 'korban' in vows (Mishnah Nedarim 1:2), and the rabbis allowed a vow harming parents to be dissolved (Mishnah Nedarim 9:1).

◆ Factbook: Oath ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

MATTHEW 15:7-9; ISAIAH 29:13

Lips near, hearts far

JESUS · MATTHEW 15:8-9

"'This people honors Me with their lips, / But their heart is far away from Me. / But in vain do they worship Me, / Teaching as doctrines the commands of men.'"

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 29:13

"Then the Lord said, / "Because this people draw near with their mouth / And honor Me with their lips, / But they remove their hearts far from Me, / And their fear of Me is in the command of men learned by rote,"

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus' train of thought tracks His earlier quotes of Hosea 6:6 (9:13; 12:7): God desires mercy that reveals a heart close to Him, which the Pharisees and scribes lack. Matthew 9:13 Matthew 12:7

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite ◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Hosea (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Mercy



Pharisees and scribes from Jerusalem

James Tissot, The Pharisees Question Jesus, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Why does a Jewish rabbi answer a question with a question? Why not?*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

What defiles a person

Plants, blind guides, and what proceeds from the heart.

MATTHEW 15:10-11

What comes out defiles

MATTHEW 15:10-11 (LSB) DEFILE

"After Jesus called the crowd to Him, He said to them, "Hear and understand. It is not what enters into the mouth that defiles the man, but what proceeds out of the mouth, this defiles the man.""

FROM THE VIDEO The video applies 'what comes out of the mouth' to the Pharisees' own teaching, the oral rules. In seeking to remain pure, they disengaged from the very things God wants them to do.

FROM THE VIDEO Halakha that comes from a right reading of God's word looks like what Jesus did: eat with sinners, heal the sick, feed the hungry, help the needy, cast out demons, often on the Sabbath.



MATTHEW 15:12-13

Plants the Father did not plant

JESUS · MATTHEW 15:13

"But He answered and said, "Every plant which My heavenly Father did not plant shall be uprooted."

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 60:21

"Then all your people will be righteous; / They will possess the land forever, / The branch of My planting, / The work of My hands, / That I may show forth My beautiful glory."

FROM THE VIDEO In many places Israel is pictured as a plant, a vine or a tree (Isaiah 60:21; Ezekiel 17:22-24; Ezekiel 16:7), until Jesus calls Himself the true vine (John 15:1). Ezekiel 17:22-24 Ezekiel 16:7 John 15:1

◆ Factbook: Tanakh



MATTHEW 15:14

Blind guides of the blind

JESUS · MATTHEW 15:14

"Let them alone; they are blind guides of the blind. And if a blind man guides a blind man, both will fall into a pit.""

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 56:10

"His watchmen are blind; / All of them know nothing. / All of them are mute dogs unable to bark, / Dreamers lying down, who love to slumber;"

FROM THE VIDEO The Lord condemns Israel's corrupt leaders and priests for turning aside and causing many to stumble by their instruction (Malachi 2:8). Malachi 2:8

FROM THE VIDEO You will recognize such teachers by the kind of teaching they teach and the students they produce (Matthew 7:15-21). Matthew 7:15-21

◆ Factbook: False prophet ◆ Factbook: Priest



MATTHEW 15:16-20; MARK 7:22

Out of the heart

❤️ MATTHEW 15:18-20 (LSB) LESSON

"But the things that proceed out of the mouth come from the heart, and those defile the man. For out of the heart come evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, sexual immoralities, thefts, false witness, slanders. These are the things which defile the man; but to eat with unwashed hands does not defile the man.""

FROM THE VIDEO 'Are you still lacking in understanding also?' (15:16). Mark's list includes pride (Mark 7:22), a corrupt desire flowing straight from the heart.

FROM THE VIDEO The lesson: beware the heart behind religious customs or traditions. If the heart behind the tradition is defiled, the tradition will violate God's word.

> *If the heart behind the tradition is defiled, the tradition will violate God's word.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The Canaanite woman

An intentional contrast: a Gentile mother's great faith.

MATTHEW 15:21-22

A Canaanite woman

MATTHEW 15:21-22 (LSB)

CONTRAST

"And going away from there, Jesus withdrew into the district of Tyre and Sidon. And behold, a Canaanite woman from that region came out and began to cry out, saying, "Have mercy on me, Lord, Son of David; my daughter is cruelly demon-possessed.""

FROM THE VIDEO Right after the leaders from Jerusalem, Jesus meets a Gentile. This is no accident: the exchange is an intentional contrast with the one before.

BACKGROUND Mark calls her 'a Greek, of Syrophoenician descent' (Mark 7:26). Matthew's 'Canaanite' recalls Israel's old enemies, yet she calls Jesus 'Son of David.' Mark 7:26

◆ Factbook: Tyre ◆ Factbook: Sidon ◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Son of David

MATTHEW 15:23-24

The lost sheep of Israel

MATTHEW 15:23-24 (LSB)

SILENCE

"But He did not answer her a word. And His disciples came and were pleading with Him, saying, "Send her away, because she keeps shouting at us." But He answered and said, "I was not sent except to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.""

BACKGROUND Jesus said the same when He sent out the Twelve (10:5-6). After the resurrection He sends them to all the nations (28:19). Matthew 10:5-6 Matthew 28:19

◆ Factbook: The Twelve

MATTHEW 15:25-27

Even the dogs

MATTHEW 15:26-27 (LSB)

“And He answered and said, “It is not good to take the children’s bread and throw it to the dogs.” But she said, “Yes, Lord; but even the dogs feed on the crumbs which fall from their masters’ table.””

FAITH

BACKGROUND The word is a diminutive, kynarion: a house dog, not a wild street dog. She takes His word and turns it into a plea.

FROM THE VIDEO Everything Jesus says and does with her reads against the Pharisees: they honored God with their lips; she bows down and cries, 'Lord, help me!'

◆ Factbook: Dog

MATTHEW 15:28

Your faith is great

🏆 MATTHEW 15:28 (LSB)

HEALED

“Then Jesus answered and said to her, “O woman, your faith is great; it shall be done for you as you wish.” And her daughter was healed at once.”

FROM THE VIDEO The religious leaders, with all their tradition, are blind guides; the Gentile woman, with nothing but her trust, is praised for great faith.

BACKGROUND Compare the centurion, another Gentile whose faith Jesus praised (8:10), and Elijah's widow of Zarephath in Sidon (1 Kings 17:9; Luke 4:26). Matthew 8:10 1 Kings 17:9

◆ Factbook: Centurion ◆ Factbook: Elijah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Widow



Even the dogs feed on the crumbs

Jean-Germain Drouais, The Woman of Canaan at the Feet of Christ, 1784. Louvre, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“This is no accident, ladies and gentlemen.*
>
> From the video

Who's who in 15:1-28

What the video says, then a short background note.

Pharisees and scribes from Jerusalem

VIDEO Ask why the disciples break the tradition of the elders.

BACKGROUND Mark explains that the Pharisees 'and all the Jews' washed carefully before eating (Mark 7:3).

Mark 7:3-4 · ◆ Pharisees · ◆ Scribe

The disciples

VIDEO Worried that the Pharisees were offended; still lacking understanding.

BACKGROUND They will ask again about this teaching (Mark 7:17).

Mark 7:17 · ◆ Disciples

Peter

VIDEO Asks, 'Explain the parable to us.'

BACKGROUND Later God teaches Peter not to call anyone unclean (Acts 10:28).

Acts 10:28 · ◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

Isaiah

VIDEO Prophesied of lips near and hearts far from God.

BACKGROUND Jesus says Isaiah 'rightly' prophesied of them (15:7).

Isaiah 29:13 · ◆ Isaiah

The Canaanite woman

VIDEO An intentional contrast with the leaders; praised for great faith.

BACKGROUND Mark calls her a Syrophoenician Greek (Mark 7:26).

Mark 7:26 · ◆ Gentiles · ◆ Tyre · ◆ Syrophoenician woman · ◆ Canaanites

Her daughter

VIDEO Cruelly demon-possessed, healed at once.

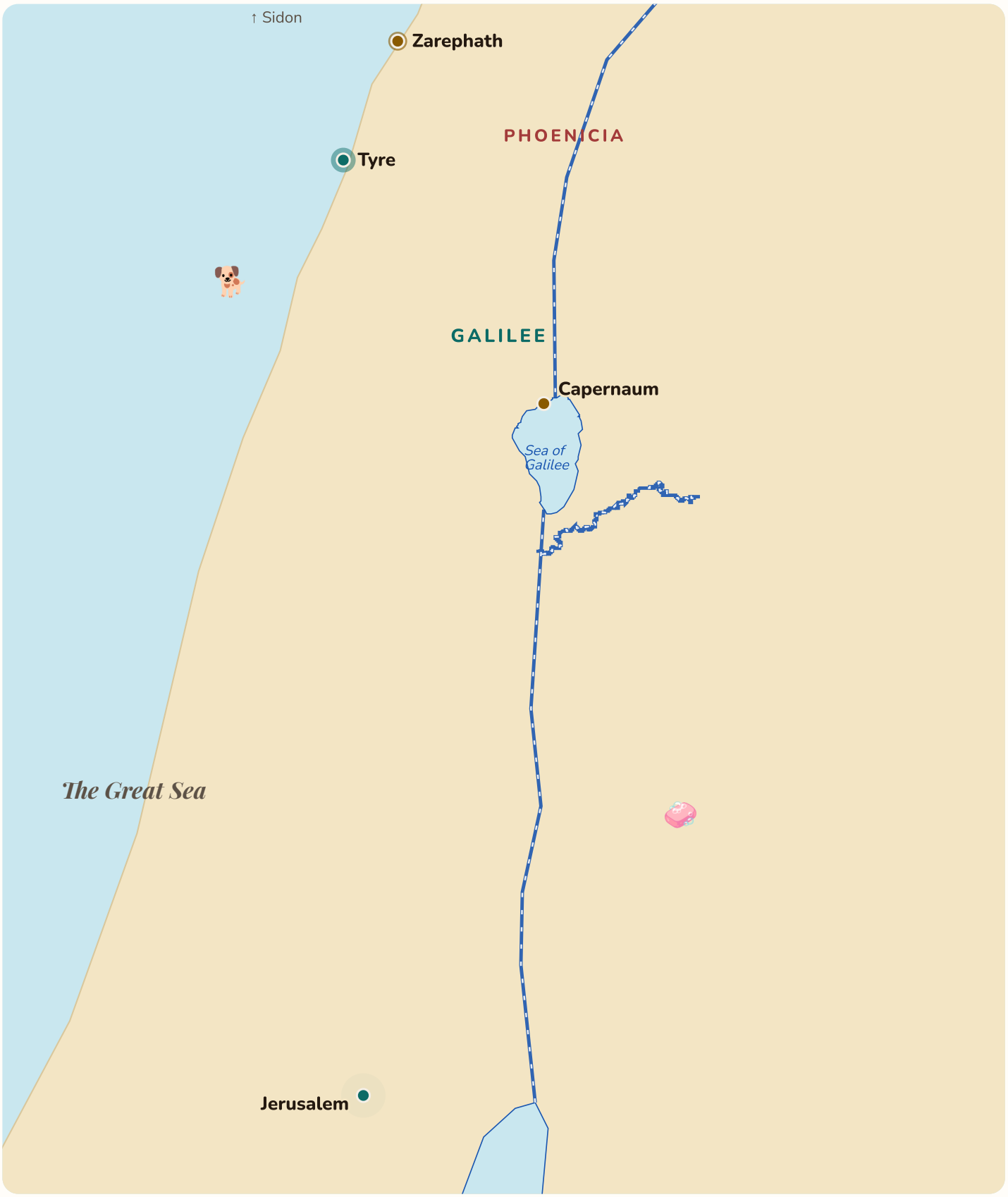
BACKGROUND Mark says the woman went home and found the demon gone (Mark 7:30).

Mark 7:30 · ◆ Demon possession

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

From Jerusalem to Tyre

Gold pins are background; the pins outlined in the video's color are places the video names.



● Named in the video ● Background

Positions from known sites; Sidon lies just north of this map. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Tyre VIDEO

Zarephath BACKGROUND

Jesus withdrew 'into the district of Tyre and Sidon' (15:21).

◆ Factbook: Tyre

A village of Sidon where Elijah was sent to a widow (1 Kings 17:9), another Gentile woman blessed.

◆ Factbook: Elijah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Zarephath

Capernaum BACKGROUND

Jesus' base in Galilee.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Jerusalem VIDEO

Where the Pharisees and scribes came from (15:1).

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem

08

Key terms

Tradition of the elders

VIDEO

The body of oral rules handed down to apply the Law; later written in the Mishnah.

◆ Factbook: Tradition of the elders

◆ Factbook: Tradition of the elders

Halakha

VIDEO

From a word for 'to walk': the rules for how to live out the Law. The captions write 'hakic' and 'helocic.'

◆ Factbook: Halakha

Corban

VIDEO

'An offering,' a vow formula declaring something given to God (Mark 7:11).

◆ Factbook: Oath ◆ Factbook: Corban

Hypocrite

VIDEO

In Greek an actor; one whose outward show hides a different heart.

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite

Defile

VIDEO

To make common or ritually unclean; Jesus locates defilement in the heart.

◆ Factbook: Unclean (ritual purity)

Remez

VIDEO

A hint back to an Old Testament passage; the captions write 'Rome.'

◆ Factbook: Tanakh

Syrophoenician

VIDEO

A Phoenician from the province of Syria, Mark's description of the woman (Mark 7:26). The captions write 'cyro phoenician.'

◆ Factbook: Syria ◆ Factbook: Syrophoenician woman

◆ Factbook: Phoenicia

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

παράδοσις

paradosis G3862

Tradition, what is handed down. Look up: BDAG, παράδοσις.

Greek · Matt 15:2, 3, 6

◆ Factbook: Tradition of the elders

◆ Factbook: Tradition of the elders

ἀκυρόω

akyroō G208

To make void, invalidate.

Greek · Matt 15:6

ὑποκριτής

hypokritēs G5273

Actor, pretender, hypocrite.

Greek · Matt 15:7

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite

κοινόω

koinoō G2840

To make common, defile.

Greek · Matt 15:11, 18, 20

◆ Factbook: Unclean (ritual purity)

φυτεία

phyteia G5451

Plant, planting.

Greek · Matt 15:13

ὁδηγός

hodēgos G3595

Guide, leader.

Greek · Matt 15:14

κυνάριον

kynarion G2952

Little dog, house dog. Look up: BDAG, κυνάριον.

Greek · Matt 15:26, 27

◆ Factbook: Dog

κορβᾶν

korban G2878

Corban, an offering given to God.

Greek · Mark 7:11

◆ Factbook: Corban

ὑπερηφανία

hyperēphania G5243

Arrogance, pride.

Greek · Mark 7:22

כָּבֵד

kabed H3513

To be heavy; in the piel, to honor. Look up: BDB or HALOT, כבד.

Hebrew · Exod 20:12

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Handwashing

Washing hands before eating was a matter of ritual purity, not hygiene. The Mishnah even sets the amount of water: 'a quarter [of a log] of water must be poured over the hands for one [person] and even for two' (Mishnah Yadayim 1:1).

A fence around the Torah

The Mishnah traces the tradition from Moses to the Men of the Great Assembly, who said, 'make a fence round the Torah' (Pirkei Avot 1:1): extra rules to keep people far from breaking the commandments.

Honoring parents

The rabbis prized this command too. The Mishnah lists 'Honoring one's father and mother' among deeds whose fruit a man enjoys in this world while the principal remains for the world to come (Mishnah Peah 1:1).

Tyre and Sidon

The Phoenician port cities north of Galilee were wealthy Gentile centers that bought grain from Galilee. Jesus had already said they would have repented had they seen His works (11:21).

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *But not the less were they innovating; as in this instance, that one ought not to eat with unwashen hands, that we must wash cups and brazen vessels, that we must wash also ourselves.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 51, on 15:2. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *And He said not, the elders' tradition, but your own.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 51, on 15:3. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *For, that food is necessary for the children, says she, I also know; yet neither am I forbidden, being a dog.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 52, on 15:27. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED **Where scholars differ**

Did Jesus set aside the food laws?

How did Corban work?

Mark adds, 'Thus He declared all foods clean' (Mark 7:19). Matthew ends with handwashing (15:20). Some read Matthew as a ruling on the elders' tradition only; others see the same teaching as Mark's.

The video says goods were pledged to the temple after the giver's death. Others think the vow simply barred parents from benefiting, with the goods never actually given. The Mishnah shows later rabbis allowed such vows to be dissolved for the parents' sake (Mishnah Nedarim 9:1).

Why the harsh word 'dogs'?

Some read Jesus as testing her faith; others as voicing the disciples' attitude to expose it; others as stating the order of His mission, 'to the Jew first.' All agree He grants her request and praises her faith.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video lists 'Leviticus 29' among the passages Jesus quotes. Leviticus has 27 chapters; the verse is Leviticus 20:9: 'If there is anyone who curses his father or his mother, he shall surely be put to death' (Leviticus 20:9).
- The Mishnah case of the poor man at the door (Mishnah Shabbat 1:1) is about who is liable for carrying between domains on the Sabbath, not a rule for how to give to the poor. Where each does part of the act, 'both of them are exempt.'
- That Corban goods went to the temple after the giver's death is one interpretation; the Gospels do not say so.
- 'To abolish means to misinterpret' is the video's view from an earlier episode, not a standard meaning of the Greek word in Matthew 5:17.
- The captions write 'hakic,' 'hocic' and 'helocic' for halakhic, 'Ty and Sidon' for Tyre and Sidon, 'Exodus 2012' for Exodus 20:12, 'cyro phoenician' for Syrophoenician, and 'Rome' for remez.

11 · BACKGROUND

From Sinai to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 15:1-28 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 BC DEBATED

'Honor your father and your mother'

Exodus 20:12 *Quoted: 15:4*

C. 870 BC DEBATED

Elijah and the widow of Zarephath in Sidon

1 Kings 17:8-16

C. 700 BC DEBATED

Isaiah: near with their mouth, hearts far from Me
Isaiah 29:13 *Quoted: 15:8-9*

C. AD 29 DEBATED
Pharisees from Jerusalem; what defiles
Matthew 15:1-20 *This episode*

C. AD 29 DEBATED
The Canaanite woman's great faith
Matthew 15:21-28 *This episode*

C. AD 200
The Mishnah writes down the oral tradition
Matthew 15:2

C. AD 390
Chrysostom: 'He said not, the elders' tradition, but your own'
Matthew 15:3

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 7:1-30
Mark's parallel
ADDED

Leviticus 20:9
Cursing father or mother
ADDED

Deuteronomy 5:16
Honor your father and mother
ADDED

Ezekiel 16:7
Like a plant of the field
ADDED

John 15:1-6
The true vine
ADDED

Matthew 7:15-21
Known by their fruits
ADDED

Acts 10:9-28
Peter learns not to call anyone unclean
ADDED

1 Timothy 5:4-8
Providing for one's own family
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. [ ] What is a custom or tradition in your church, and what is the heart behind it?
2. [ ] How can a good rule end up voiding God's word? Can you think of an example?
3. [ ] Where might you honor God with your lips while your heart is far away?
4. [ ] Jesus says defilement comes from the heart. Which item in His list (or Mark's 'pride') do you most need to watch?
5. [ ] What stands out to you in the contrast between the leaders from Jerusalem and the Canaanite woman?
6. [ ] How does her persistence shape the way you pray?

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson for Jesus' original audience: beware the heart behind religious customs or traditions. If the heart behind the tradition is defiled, the tradition will violate God's word. There are all kinds of implications, whether for Jesus' day or our own, but that is what Jesus wants His people to hear and understand. How do we know whether a tradition of our church violates God's word? We must be careful and investigate whether the customs and traditions of our local church reflect the heart of God. Customs and traditions are habitual ways of acting among a group; many churches have clearly delineated practices that are liturgical and have theological and doctrinal purposes, such as corporately affirming certain creeds. The question is not whether we have traditions, but whether the heart behind them is close to the Lord.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

pick one habit in your own worship, private or public. Ask what it is for, where it comes from in Scripture, and whether it helps you love God and neighbor or has become a way around them.

> *"Beware the heart behind religious customs or traditions.*
>
> From the video

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Malachi ◆ Isaiah ◆ Pharisees ◆ Repentance ◆ Galilee
◆ Elijah (prophet) ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Mount Sinai (Horeb) ◆ Capernaum
◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Worship ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Adultery ◆ Almsgiving ◆ Demon possession
◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Gentiles ◆ Healing ◆ Hypocrite ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Mercy
◆ Mishnah ◆ Oath ◆ Tradition of the elders ◆ Prayer ◆ Scribe ◆ Sea of Galilee
◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Syria ◆ The Twelve ◆ Widow ◆ Centurion ◆ Dog ◆ False prophet
◆ Halakha ◆ Hosea (the prophet) ◆ Priest ◆ Sinner ◆ Tanakh ◆ Parable ◆ Rabbi ◆ Sidon
◆ Son of David ◆ Tyre ◆ Sabbath ◆ Canaanites ◆ Cedar ◆ Unclean (ritual purity) ◆ Corban
◆ Men of the Great Assembly ◆ Phoenicia ◆ Syrophoenician woman ◆ Tradition of the elders ◆ Zarephath

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